SUPPLIER PROPOSAL | RESPONSE TO RFP-2026-041

Enterprise Procurement & Supplier Management Platform

Submitted to Northstar Manufacturing Group

BrightPath Technologies

Technical, Implementation, Commercial and Service Response

Proposal reference	BPT-26-087
Submission date	18 October 2026
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Proposal validity	90 calendar days from submission

Executive Summary

BrightPath offers a lightweight SaaS product focused on fast supplier onboarding, RFQ circulation and basic approval tracking. Its proposal is the lowest-priced and shortest implementation option. The product is largely standardised and can be configured quickly, but several enterprise controls requested by Northstar are either roadmap items or require manual workarounds. BrightPath proposes a 12-week launch for core workflows, with a later phase for advanced integrations.

Important note: This document is fictional, created solely for testing a classroom RFP evaluation application. Supplier names, contacts, certifications, customer references, performance claims and commercial amounts are synthetic and must not be treated as real-world claims.

1. Technical Capability and Solution Fit

1.1 Proposed architecture

The BrightPath One platform is a single-tenant application built as a conventional web application with a shared relational database schema. The supplier portal and buyer workspace use the same application tier. The bidder reports a recent test with 300 registered accounts and 60 concurrent users; it did not provide a load-test report or performance percentile. Standard reports are generated from operational tables. There is no separate event-streaming layer; outbound integrations use scheduled jobs.

1.2 Integration approach

A standard CSV import/export package is available for supplier master data and purchase-order references. Entra ID SSO is listed as a paid roadmap enhancement planned for the next two quarters; current login uses email and password with optional one-time email codes. SAP integration is not included in the quoted price. BrightPath proposes nightly CSV transfer through a buyer-managed secure folder as an interim arrangement. Microsoft 365 notifications are email-based only.

1.3 Functional scope

Supplier self-registration, configurable document checklist, RFQ invitation and response upload, basic bid comparison, two-step approval, contract attachment storage and six standard dashboards. The current release does not support automated contract clause extraction, supplier corrective-action workflow or field-level audit history. Approval delegation is administrator-managed. Supplier risk flags are manual tags.

1.4 Buyer environment and common scope

The response is made against the same Northstar requirements supplied to all bidders:

- **Buyer and programme:** Northstar Manufacturing Group (fictional) operates four manufacturing plants and three regional offices in India. The programme covers approximately 1,200 employees, 500 potential platform users and 180 active suppliers.
- **Required workflows:** Supplier registration and onboarding; document collection and due diligence; RFQ creation and supplier responses; configurable evaluation scorecards; multi-level approvals; contract and certificate repository; supplier performance reviews; and spend / sourcing dashboards.
- **Enterprise environment:** The buyer currently uses SAP S/4HANA for finance and purchasing, Microsoft Entra ID for identity, and Microsoft 365 for collaboration. REST APIs, SSO and role-based access are expected. CSV exchange may be used only as a documented interim workaround.
- **Security and resilience expectations:** The buyer expects MFA, encryption in transit and at rest, audit trails, vulnerability management, independent security testing, India data-residency clarity, a documented incident process, 99.9% monthly availability, target RTO of four hours and target RPO of one hour.

2. Implementation Plan and Commercial Proposal

2.1 Delivery plan and milestones

BrightPath proposes 12 weeks. Weeks 1-2: process workshop and tenant setup. Weeks 3-5: supplier forms and document templates. Weeks 6-7: RFQ and approval configuration. Weeks 8-9: data import and report setup. Weeks 10-11: UAT and administrator training. Week 12: launch. SAP CSV exchange and SSO are identified as post-launch workstreams, with no committed delivery date in this proposal. The buyer must provide cleaned supplier spreadsheets and final document templates by the end of week 2.

Milestone	Evidence / exit condition
Design approval	Signed solution design, scope and responsibility matrix
Configuration complete	Configured workflows, roles and supplier forms available in test
Integration and migration	Interface test evidence and reconciled migration totals
User acceptance	Buyer-approved test results and defect disposition
Go-live	Cutover checklist, training completion and support handover

2.2 Commercial schedule (INR, excluding GST)

Cost component	Amount
One-time setup and configuration	INR 8,00,000
CSV import/export setup	INR 2,00,000
Annual subscription (500 users)	INR 16,00,000
Standard support (business hours)	Included
Year 1 total before taxes	INR 26,00,000
Three-year total before taxes	INR 58,00,000

The three-year total assumes annual subscription remains unchanged. Additional storage above 500 GB costs INR 60,000 per year per 250 GB. Custom reports are INR 35,000 each. SSO, SAP API integration and 24x7 support are not included and will be separately estimated after requirements sign-off. GST is extra. Payment terms are 50% at order and 50% at launch.

2.3 Commercial assumptions and exclusions

The quote is based on 500 users, 500 GB storage and standard workflows. SAP integration, SSO, data migration beyond spreadsheet import and custom development are excluded. Buyer is responsible for secure file transfer and reconciliation of CSV jobs. All prices are exclusive of GST.

3. Security, Compliance, Support and Delivery Risks

3.1 Information security and compliance

BrightPath states that its hosting provider is ISO 27001 certified; the bidder has not supplied its own ISO 27001 certificate or a SOC 2 report. Data is hosted in an India region, but the proposal does not identify the exact cloud region or provide a contractual data-residency commitment. TLS is used for browser traffic; encryption at rest is described as a hosting-provider default. MFA is not mandatory for all accounts. The current audit log records user login and key record creation, but not all field changes. A third-party penetration test is planned for Q1 2027; no current report was attached.

3.2 Availability, backup and disaster recovery

The standard service target is 99.5% monthly availability. Backups are performed daily and retained for 14 days. BrightPath has not committed an RTO or RPO in the proposal. The bidder describes a manual recovery procedure but has not supplied evidence of a recent disaster recovery exercise.

3.3 Support model and service levels

Standard support is available Monday-Friday, 9:30 a.m.-6:00 p.m. IST, excluding public holidays. Tickets are handled through email and a web portal. The stated response target is one business day for all severities; no restoration target is committed. A named customer success contact is included for the first 90 days. Training comprises two remote administrator sessions and one recorded supplier webinar.

3.4 Key risks and dependencies

The quoted cost excludes SAP API integration, mandatory enterprise SSO and 24x7 incident coverage. The nightly CSV workaround may delay supplier and purchasing updates and requires buyer-operated monitoring. Current audit, resilience and security evidence is limited. The proposed 12-week schedule applies to the core product only and should not be treated as a complete enterprise integration timeline.

3.5 Relevant customer experience and references

Reference A: GreenBasket Distributors (fictional), 120 users, onboarding and RFQ modules, live since 2025. Reference B: Kaveri Office Supplies (fictional), 80 users, document checklist and basic approvals, live since 2024. References are small and mid-market deployments; comparable multi-plant enterprise references were not provided.

4. Closing Statement

BrightPath Tech appreciates the opportunity to respond to RFP-2026-041. The statements in this proposal are submitted for evaluation against the buyer's requirements and are subject to contract, final design validation and mutually agreed acceptance criteria.

Authorized representative: Ananya Rao, Product Sales Lead

End of proposal. All case data in this PDF is synthetic and intended for software testing only.